The ten questions before signing.

The standard to negotiate: capped hybrid. A base fee, consumption, a cap, and spend guards included. Then ten questions to work through before any signature.

#	QUESTION	ANSWER OBTAINED	OK?
1	A comparable customer's actual invoice: units, volumes, surprises		☐
2	What happens at the cap: block, surcharge, or silent degradation?		☐
3	Consumption-management tools included: dashboards, alerts, configurable caps		☐
4	SLA on answer reliability, not just availability		☐
5	Contractual guarantees on my data: usage, training, deletion, location		☐
6	Pilot success metrics co-signed before kickoff		☐
7	Guaranteed pricing trajectory, and what triggers a review		☐
8	Reversibility: what I get back if I leave (data, configurations, memory, history)		☐
9	Your dependencies (models, cloud, energy), how they are passed through to me—and the energy footprint of my usage		☐
10	Which layer am I paying for, and which rung of the ladder am I climbing?		☐

The urgent thing is to wait—before committing, not before acting. No firm commitment beyond the horizon at which you could still exit, which today is roughly eighteen months. Short, renewable contracts with review clauses.